Who gets COUNTED?

Rwanda records almost every birth. When a citizen dies, the record goes quiet for one in every two. This is the story of the half that is counted, the half that is not, and who is missing from the page.

92.9%
BIRTHS REGISTERED, 2025

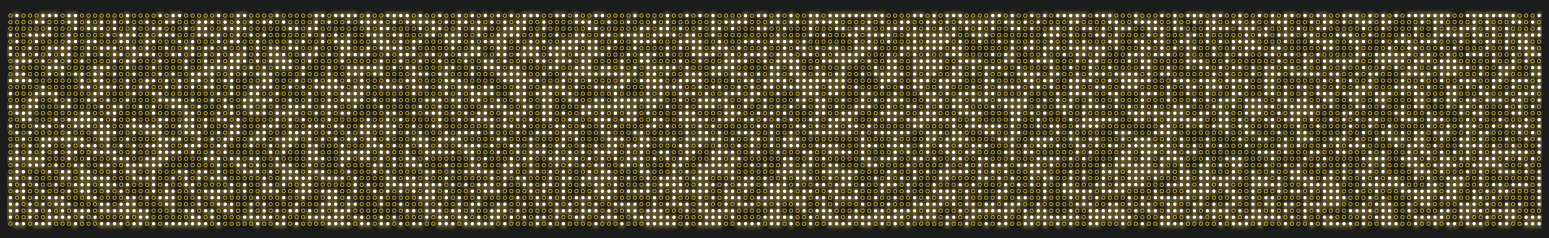
50.5%
DEATHS REGISTERED, 2025

38,521

EXPECTED DEATHS NOT REGISTERED IN 2025

Of 77,876 expected deaths, 39,355 were registered in-year. Each dot is ten people.

REGISTERED · NOT REGISTERED



01 · THE MISSING WOMEN

TABLE 12

57.9% of the uncounted are women

MEN
57.6%
22,051 of 38,262 expected deaths registered

WOMEN
43.7%
17,304 of 39,614 expected deaths registered



EXPECTED · MEN REGISTERED · WOMEN REGISTERED

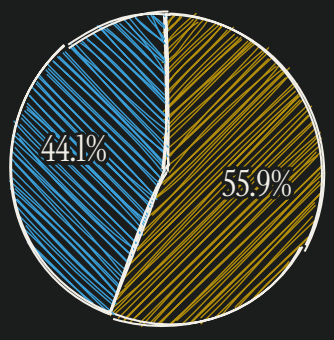
> A death certificate is demanded when land changes hands. Land mostly changes hands when a man dies.

Certificates unlock succession, land transfer and bank accounts, which sit mostly with men. **22,310 women** and 16,211 men went unregistered in 2025: a 13.9-point completeness gap.

02 · WHERE PEOPLE DIE

TABLE 14

Most deaths happen at home



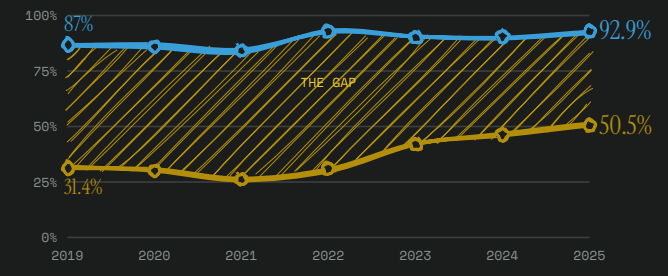
District extremes, 2025	Home	Facility
Muhanga	67.2%	32.8%
Nyaruguru	66.0%	34.0%
Nyarugenge	33.9%	66.1%
Kicukiro	32.3%	67.7%
Rwanda	**55.9%**	**44.1%**

A facility death is logged at the bedside. A home death depends on a family travelling to the cell office with two witnesses within 30 days. In rural districts, two in three deaths happen at home.

03 · SEVEN YEARS ON THE RECORD

TABLE 10.6

Births are solved. Deaths are not.



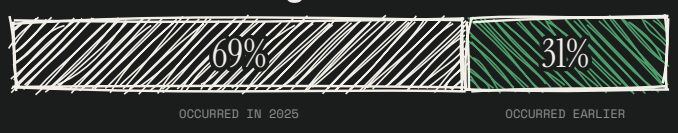
BIRTHS · DEATHS

Death registration rose from **31.4% in 2019 to 50.5% in 2025**, with a dip to 26.2% in 2021 and the steepest climb, 10.7 points, between 2022 and 2023. Births have stayed above 84% throughout, carried by facility deliveries.

04 · BACKLOG AND THE CLOCK

TABLE 11 · FIG. 18

A third of 2025's registrations were old deaths



OCCURRED IN 2025 · 39,355

EARLIER YEARS · 17,712

LATE, 2024
3.7%
registered after the 30-day window

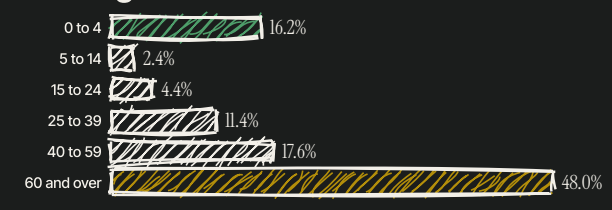
LATE, 2025
10.1%
registered after the 30-day window

Mop-up campaigns pushed 17,712 earlier deaths into the register in 2025. At the same time late registration nearly tripled: more deaths captured, but more of them arriving after the deadline.

05 · WHO APPEARS IN THE RECORD

TABLE 11

Half of registered deaths are over 60

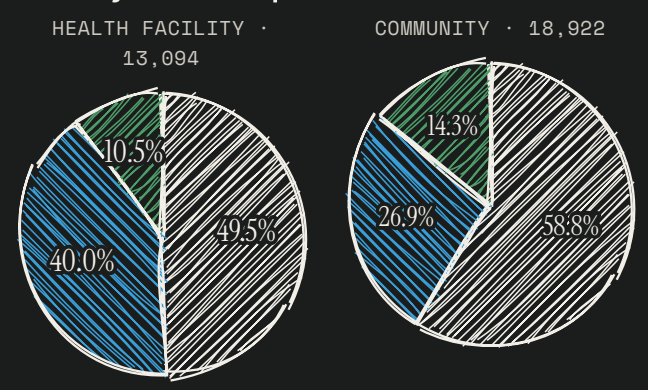


Age at death	Deaths	%
0 to 4	6,393	16.2
5 to 14	950	2.4
15 to 24	1,731	4.4
25 to 39	4,473	11.4
40 to 59	6,913	17.6
60 and over	18,895	48.0
Occurred and registered in 2025	**39,355**	**100.0**

06 · WHAT THE RECORD SAYS

FIG. 23–25

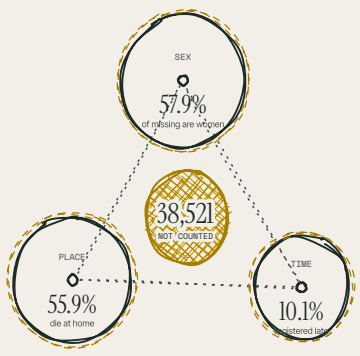
Where you die shapes the cause on file



NON-COMMUNICABLE

COMMUNICABLE, MATERNAL, PERINATAL · INJURIES

Facilities document infections (40.0% against 26.9%). Community deaths, certified by verbal autopsy, lean to long illnesses (58.8%). A register that grows only through facilities will drift towards what hospitals see.



THREE DRIVERS, ONE GAP · RWANDA'S 2030 TARGET IS 80% COMPLETENESS

Now close the gap.

Place, sex and time pull on the same 38,521 people. A woman who dies at home, with no land in her name, is the person the system is least likely to ever count. On its current trend the register reaches roughly 67% by 2030. Three levers, each aimed at one driver, decide whether it crosses 80%.

+8 pts
Village health worker reporting
Let community health workers file a death notice by phone, so a home death enters the system without a journey. Targets place.

+7 pts
Remove barriers for women
Decouple certificates from inheritance, waive late fees for deceased mothers and daughters, link registration to social protection. Targets sex.

+5 pts
Digital registration points
Cell-level kiosks and mobile registration days that make the 30-day window reachable. Targets time.

SOURCE

National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda, *Rwanda Vital Statistics Report 2025* (CRVS system data, 2019–2025). Tables 10.5, 10.6, 11, 12, 14; Figures 16–19, 23–25. Expected deaths 77,876 and registered deaths 39,355 from Table 12. Every figure reconciles to the published tables.

COMPETITION
NISR 2026

TEAM
Team Shujazz · two students

COMPANION
Dynamic infographic, nine chapters

DATE
October 2026